

FRAGMENTS of a FADING MIND



A Collection of Unspoken Verses

YASH AGRAWALL

Fragments of a Fading Mind

By Yash Agrawal

Dedication

To every version of me I had to abandon to survive.
To the silent moments,
the forgotten feelings,
and the fragile truths that never found a voice—
until now.

Author's Note

What you are feeling right now might seem like it's going to last forever—
an endless loop of agonizing pain. But it won't.

You might believe this is the worst thing that could happen to you—
but it isn't.

There will be moments when you feel the crushing weight
of dreams and hopes others have placed upon your shoulders.
You'll question your choices,
and how you became the version of yourself you see today.

People won't notice how overwhelmed you are—
or how overwhelmingly they are overwhelming you,
again and again.

The torment might feel infinite.
But it isn't.

It will end.
And when it does,
the blur of suffering will slowly dissolve
in the brightness of who you truly are.

This book was born in such moments.
If you're reading it during yours—
I hope it feels like a flicker of light.

— *Yash Agrawal*

Preface: Fragments of a Fading Mind

We are all a little unfinished—stitched together by memories we try to forget, feelings we barely understand, and voices we silence before they even speak. This book is not a solution, nor a conclusion. It's a mirror—shattered, but still reflecting.

Each poem in this collection is a fragment of that fading mind—mine, yours, anyone who has ever sat with their own silence and heard it scream. You will find anger, loss, resilience, dissociation, numbness, the chaos of thought, and occasionally, the whisper of hope.

This book is for those who feel too much and say too little. For those who write because the heart doesn't know how else to bleed. For those still picking up their own pieces in silence.

You are not alone.

— Yash Agrawall

Section I: Disillusionment & Descent

- Shadows of Adulthood – on growing up and fading innocence
- The Next Chapter – shifting identity, self-reflection
- Strength in Solitude – loneliness as strength
- Modern Madness – mental unrest in a fast world
- System – existential critique, feeling trapped
- Matrix – surrealism and simulated realities

Shadows of Adulthood

Life is so cruel, but I'm hanging on,
I've got friends, but I'm still feeling alone.
I'm still going out, wearing that cheap cologne,
Going out and wanting to go back home.

I guess this is called adulting,
Where you find bitching interesting,
Where you are always on your phone,
And still pretend to be busy with your daily chores.

Losing interest in everything you used to like,
Wanting to leave everything and start a new life.
Nothing seems to be your type,
Life's so straight and monotone.

Where is the joyful kid who was excited for everything?
Now nothing seems to be as fascinating.
Sitting all alone and calling it chilling,
Adulting is literally so boring.

Burdened by responsibilities,
Cause now you are not a teen.
If you want to have a good life,
Then ignore everything that comes in between.

Reflection:

This piece carries the bittersweet realization of growing up. It traces the loss of wonder and the burdens of responsibility with both reverence and resignation.

The Next Chapter

Lived around my parents all the time,
Now have to live a thousand miles away.
For the stairs of life that I have to climb,
Being the potter and also the clay.

I am responsible for what I do;
I cannot start doing drugs like a fool,
Can't do absurd things and act cool—
I must burn my every joule.

Have to work and study hard every day;
Love is a hunter, and I cannot be its prey.
No room for my motivation to decay,
No matter what this two-faced world may say.
By hook or crook, I'll find my own way.

Reflection:

A poetic meditation on the inevitability of change. This piece captures the uncomfortable liminality between who we were and who we're becoming. It's about surrendering to time's quiet transformations, even when we feel unready.

Strength in Solitude

You are nobody's responsibility.
You have no one for your mental stability.
No one texts you just to check up on you;
They text because they have some work for you.

The world wears a mask; it's not like Disney.
You have to be tough and let your softness fade swiftly.
They would ignore your texts and act all busy.
You have to live alone, and I know it's not easy.

You must cage your feelings and live with all of this.
Anything you say to anyone would be used against you.
Everyone's a snake, and in the end, they all will hiss.
In the end, if there's no one, you'll always have you.

You cannot be naive and gullible.
You cannot cry about it or be sentimental.
You have to stand when the world pulls you down.
Turn your weakness into strength and wear it like a crown.

Reflection:

A celebration of quiet resilience. This poem transforms loneliness into power, painting solitude not as isolation, but as a space where the self-reclaims its strength and purpose.

MODERN MADNESS

Welcome to the twenty-first century,
Where everyone should be in a penitentiary.
People often engage in adultery,
And ignore every useful advisory.

A world where breathing is hazardous,
And every second there's a risk of a new virus.
But people are counting the number of genders,
And the most secure job is that of a bartender.

A world where a chicken fights an old beast,
Wins because it was scripted and was on Netflix.
People do indiscriminate things and call it mental peace,
Any inconvenience occurs, and they call the damn priest.

People have best friends with whom they hang out,
But behind their backs, it's them they bitch about.
People are so selfish, they don't see their foul,
If somebody is naive, he's brain rot from in and out.

A world where criminals are glorified,
Rapists wander free and contest elections with pride.
At first, people are horrified and do a riot nationwide,
At last, they do a retweet, and slowly the fire dies.

A new world war is always on the rise,
Innocent civilians always die, with tears in their eyes.
Artificial intelligence is destroying people's lives,
I don't think anyone would survive or thrive.

Reflection:

Chaotic, fragmented, and honest, this poem mirrors the disorienting pace of modern life. It resonates with anyone who's ever felt overwhelmed by screens, systems, and silent expectations.

SYSTEM

Starting my day at night,
Working hard to get every question right.
Also, I have a reduced appetite,
Filling all of my terabytes.

I am so sleep deprived,
Practicing everything Newton derived.
Never kept books out of my sight,
Forgot about my hobbies and likes,
Doing everything to get a good life.

Not complaining about the system,
Of which every student is a victim.
Increasing number of cases of suicides,
Of the students who were fragile.

They don't understand the pressure,
They don't understand the depression.
All they did was install springs,
That barely changed anything.

Reflection:

A critique of conformity and control. This poem exposes how institutions dull individuality, and how easy it is to forget we once had fire in us.

MATRIX

I don't believe in college,
I don't believe in schools.
They're just producing laborers,
They're just making fools.

What will you do with a degree,
If you don't have the knowledge?
Just some learned-up debris,
That won't be useful after college.

The grey-haired will tag this as
Some nonsense of Gen-Z,
'Cause they themselves have
Been pressed by the control key.

But I decide not to be
A determinant of this matrix.
They just teach you unnecessary stuff,
But you are as useful as the appendix.

Mugging up information,
Forgetting it after the examination,
Serving degree-less people,
Making it your occupation.

This matrix is run by people,
Who themselves broke through.
Money is all you need to make,
No matter how you do.

I don't believe in college,
I don't believe in schools.
They're just producing laborers,
They're just making fools.

Reflection:

This piece carries the bittersweet realization of growing up. It traces the loss of wonder and the burdens of responsibility with both reverence and resignation.

Section II: Loss, Grief & Memory

- Death – abstract mourning
- Cancer – a raw personal decay
- That Friend – nostalgic heartbreak
- My Best Friend – youthful attachment turned memory
- A Desolated Guy – emptiness and longing

DEATH

Silence,
The endless reign of peace and neutrality.
Drowning in the infinite ocean of nothingness.
Breaking the link between the perpetual and the transient.
Liberation from an agonized body,
Emancipation of the eternal soul.
Discontinuation of existence from the unnatural world,
Expiration of everything that it earned or had.
Termination of wants and wills,
Eradication of emotions,
Annihilation of fear,
Extirpation of life.
Just emptiness resides.

Reflection:

Rather than eulogizing loss, this poem deconstructs death as a philosophical presence. It explores how death lives among us, quietly influencing our choices, fears, and moments of courage.

CANCER

I'm not doing quite well,
Dying off this cancerous hell.
Coughing out blood,
Loving its taste afterwards.

Used to smoke a hundred packets a day,
Wasn't able to control the urge anyway.
Now the doctor says,
Nothing can be done.
And in my last days,
I'm being a burden.

Went to the barber to shave off my hair,
At first, he stared, and then he shaved his own hair.
Everyone is taking so much care,
While drowning in the ocean of despair.

Coughing and losing my breath;
Chemo can only delay death.
Taking a hundred pills a day,
Losing muscles and losing weight.

Wish I'd learned my lesson earlier,
Wish I'd chosen to be healthier;
Wish I didn't go for the second burn,
Should have addressed people's concern.

Reflection:

Raw, haunting, and deeply human, this poem is about both physical illness and the metaphorical cancers that eat away at us—grief, guilt, memory.

THAT FRIEND

I'm a friend that would stand by you,
No matter what you're going through.
I'll try to ease the pain for you,
I promise to be there for you.

But I don't know where we went wrong,
Now you don't even pick up my calls.
I just want to talk it out,
But I just don't know how.
Even if I try, you say, "Not right now."

I'm always waiting for your replies,
You just leave mine on liked.
It's been a long time,
Without your face in my eyes.

You are always on a curfew,
When I want to see you.
I'm sorry if I did something wrong,
But I'm sure it wasn't intentional at all.

Yell at me if I hurt you,
Tell me where I was wrong,
Talk to me and figure it out,
But please don't switch things off.

Reflection:

Tender and nostalgic, this piece is an ode to friendships that once meant the world. It captures how people fade from our lives, not always with drama but with distance.

My Best Friend

I miss you so badly,
You were always there for me.
The way you cared,
You were my best friend.

Gave me all the happiness,
You were so selfless.
But I lost you in a sec,
You died from a heart attack.

Gazing at the celestial stars in the night sky,
Wondering which star is my grandma.
I wasn't ready to say goodbye,
Just wish to talk to you one last time.

Grandpa is so lonely,
He waits for his time only.
He sits alone in the chair,
Staring at the other pair.
He won't go out,
Sits and cries in a corner of the house.

We had it all
When we had you.
Now we stare at the wall,
'Cause it has the picture of you.

Reflection:

More personal and grounded than "That Friend," this poem is a love letter to childhood bonds, innocence, and the first time we feel truly seen.

A Desolated Guy

I always find myself in a mess,
In no time, I curse my existence.
I'm done with hating myself (every time),
When will this phase come to an end?

I don't deserve this kind of life.
How about ending it before time?
Continuously thinking about suicide.

I guess I'm depressed.
When I think of the reason,
There's not one,
But there's a whole damn list.
How about me ceasing to exist?

It's difficult handling this pressure
And depression.
Attending lectures
And saying, "Yes, sir."
Got a rope of beautiful texture.
How would the prints look on my neck,
And later on my picture?

My mind's out of place,
Nothing is going great.
I need someone to ease the pain,
But people are driving me insane.
Honestly, I know they don't care.

The world is too complicated for me to exist.
Everybody's a peck sniff.
People say something
And believe something else.
Nobody's got control over themselves.

Oh, I don't know what to do, actually.
Suffocating in this body,
Bruises in my heart,
Also have a wrecked mind,
Trying to fight for my life.

There's no one to save me,
All my efforts go in vain.
Not every ending is beaming,
But the sooner the ending,
The lesser the pain.

Reflection:

A poem of silent suffering. It portrays emotional numbness as a slow-burning storm inside a quiet exterior—a voice for those who struggle unseen.

Section III: Reflections of the Self

- Human Paradox – introspective contradiction
- Burnt Petals – emotional wear and fragmentation

HUMAN PARADOX

Fighting with myself in my mind;
I don't want to think what I'm thinking.
Not following rules, didn't even try;
Hearing rumours that messed up my life.

I don't know where to find peace;
Just want to put my mind at ease.
I don't really understand this species,
Looking at a camera and saying "cheese."
Investing in every other filth,
Not realizing they are actually bills.

Why are humans so complicated?
Why do they have to make filth overrated?
They would love their pets,
And keep them domesticated.

Why can't they be simple,
And not follow every other ritual?
Why do they have to make stupid rules,
And waste all of their joules?

Setting up courts and laws,
But not getting justice at all.
Having police for our safety,
But they don't monitor each and every activity.

Doctors are on duty,
But people are dying from acidity.
Politicians are at work,

Most of them are a bunch of jerks.
Where are we heading this way?
Being the hunter and also the prey.

Can we all please come together?
And try to make things better?
Build a sustainable future,
Instead of abusing each other.

Reflection:

This reflection grapples with contradictions within us all. It probes the tension between empathy and cruelty, connection and isolation—making it a philosophical cornerstone of the collection.

Burnt Petals

I held her like flowers to my chest,
Was so addicted that I even forgot meth.
A year later, I learned flowers have thorns,
And every relationship has its pros and cons.

I hoped that she'd be my forever woman;
Thought that she would never abandon.
A year later, I learned hoping is like shooting arrows in the dark,
At first, you think there is a special spark.

I invested all of my time and energy in her,
Thought that I would never have my vision blurred.
A year later, I learned these aren't investments, they are bills,
All of her memories that are left with me kill.

Reflection:

A beautiful metaphor for emotional exhaustion. Like petals scorched by too much sun, it speaks to beauty lost in the heat of experience, and the pain of being touched too deeply.

Section IV: Fleeting Light

- Titanic – love in ruin
- The Proposal – tender sincerity
- Us – a balance of emotion and realism

TITANIC

Looking at a picture of you,
Falling for you more and more,
I just can't take my eyes off you,
You are so beautiful.

Your eyes are like an ocean,
I'm on a ship,
It's so amazing with you,
I don't care if it's Titanic.

I'm done watching you in 2D,
I want you next to me,
Tell me how that can be,
Oh, I admire you deeply.

Every night I think about us,
I can't say much but,
I'm captivated by you, and that's certain.
Tell me, do you feel the same way?

Reflection:

Using the famed ship as metaphor, it explores grand love destined for ruin. There's beauty in its inevitability, and sadness in its predictability.

The Proposal

I warned you,
My hands will be around your waist,
And you cannot get away.
We'll be dancing all night,
Without caring about time.
The playlist is on shuffle,
And you are my date.

Years have passed,
I still care for you deeply.
You are the one,
I send you a text,
Not a minute, and it's read.
Ask you to send a pic,
And you say, "Already sent."

Now it's the 3rd of May,
We're having dinner at my place.
You find a ring in your champagne,
I told you...
Marry me and take my last name.

Reflection:

A sincere moment of emotional exposure. Unlike the other romantic poems, this one feels grounded, vulnerable, and quietly courageous.

US

Hey you!
You have no clue
How much I care for you,
You are the only one for me.

Yeah, we!
We are so fine,
You are my sunshine,
Together, we catch the vibe.

So let me take you on a date!
This isn't just some kind of game,
Achieving this connection is my only aim.
Please stay with me forever,
I will try to do what's best for us.

You are always on my mind,
I can think of you constantly.
Nothing can ever keep us apart,
You reside in my heart.

Reflection:

A poetic middle ground—neither too idealistic nor bitter. It recognizes that relationships are defined by both presence and impermanence.

Section V: The Last Fragment

- Fragments of a Fading Mind – exclusive final poem

Fragments Of A Fading Mind

I was never truly complete—
just flickers of thought
and echoes of feeling,
scattered across too many unfinished pages.

There are names I don't say,
faces I avoid recalling,
places I don't revisit,
and memories that leave me caged.

Some days,
I am the silence
between what I feel
and what I show.
Other days,
I am all noise—
hoping someone hears
something unspoken.

If I seem silent and distant,
forgive me.
It's just me,
fighting a war within—
trying to gather the pieces of myself
I lost along the way.

Grief never asks permission.
It just shows up,
knocks on your door,
and turns your mind into a prison.
That's when you need your friends—
to remind you
that the key was never really lost.

About the Author

Yash Agrawal is a poet of quiet intensity. His words come from places most people avoid—grief, solitude, fading friendships, and the space between thoughts. He doesn't write to impress but to process, to document what gets lost in translation between the heart and the world.

His work has been featured in multiple national and independent anthologies, including *Be Limitless* (presented at NDWBF 2025), *Mesmerize*, *Cloud of Thoughts*, *The Chaotic Cosmic Muse*, and others. Each piece he pens adds to a growing body of work that is raw, introspective, and deeply human.

Fragments of a Fading Mind is not just a book—it's a quiet rebellion against emotional suppression. It speaks for the parts of ourselves that feel too much, too often. Yash believes poetry doesn't need to rhyme or resolve—it just needs to be real.

When he's not writing, Yash immerses himself in music, photography, philosophy, and the subtle art of reflection.

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For Your Fragment....